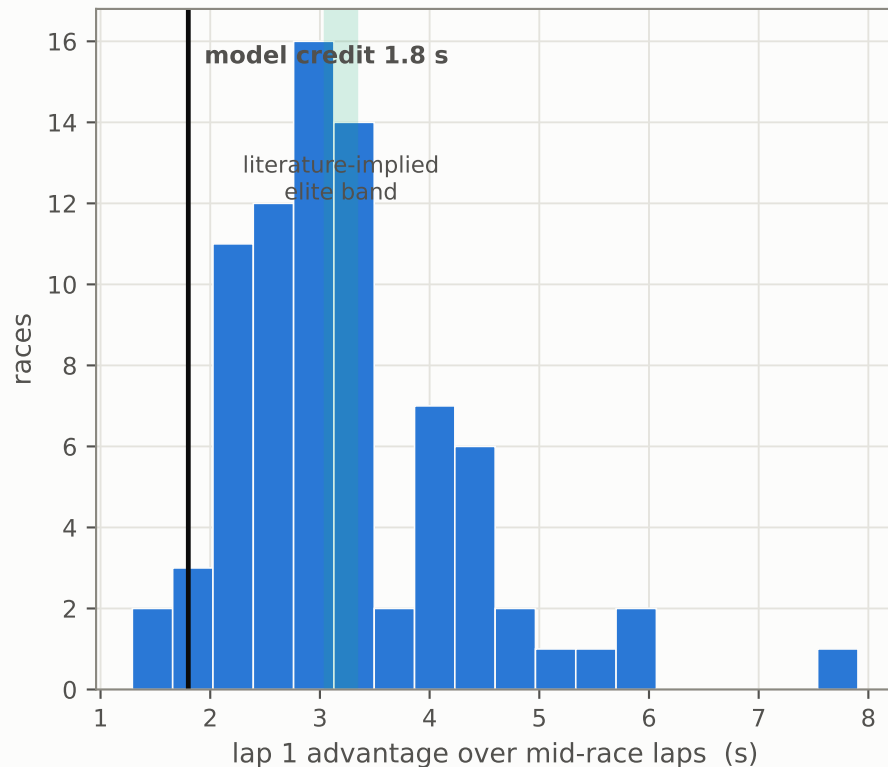
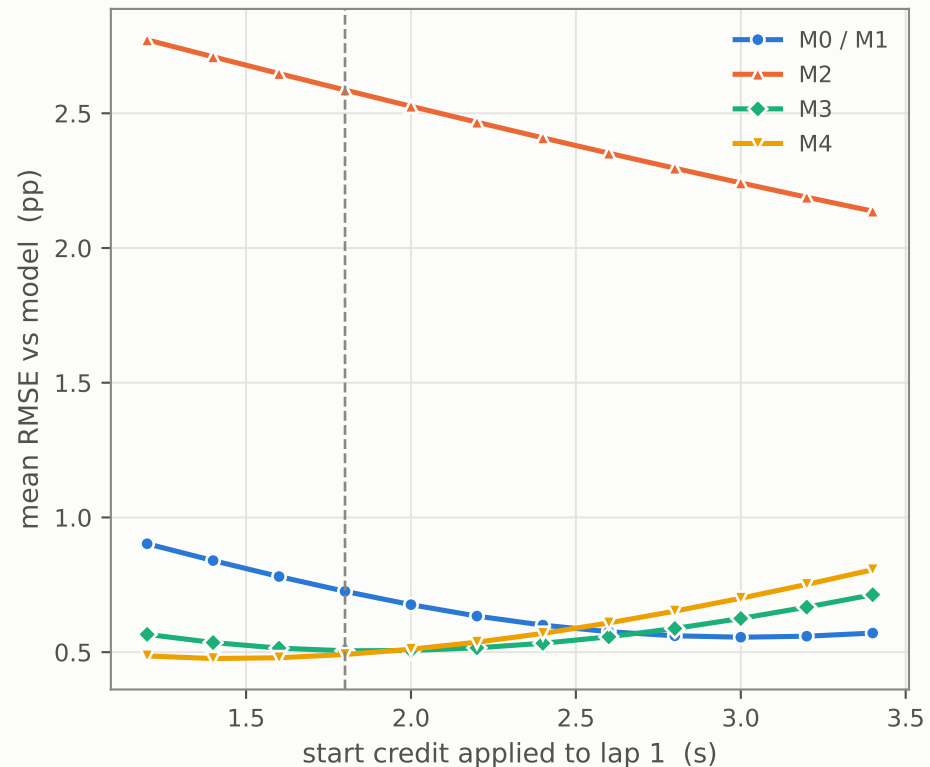


How much faster the first lap actually is



Model ranking across the start-credit band



Left: the raw lap-1 advantage over mid-race laps, against the elite-anchored model credit (line) and the dive value implied by elite 15 m start times at THIS field's race pace (band). Right: mean RMSE of free-swimming-equivalent shares against each model across the start-credit band; where the curves cross, the ranking depends on the credit, which is why measuring it beats assuming it.